

ABF-FST Digital Respondent Portal — Screen and Button Reference

Every screen and every button: what it does, when to use it, why it exists and what happens next.

STUDY	Developing and Validating the Agribusiness Bankability Framework for Food Systems Transformation through Novel Financing Models in Zimbabwe (ABF-FST)
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Screenshots in this document use **fictional demonstration data**. Organisation and person names, phone numbers and figures shown in them are not real study records.

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1. About this reference

The other manuals tell you how to do a task, step by step. This one is the opposite: it takes every screen of the ABF-FST Research Operations Centre and, for each button, field and choice on it, says what it does, when to use it, **why it exists** and **what you will see next**.

Use it when you wonder “what does this button do?”, “why is it greyed out?” or “what happens if I press it?”. It is written from the actual screens, so the labels are the ones you see.

How each table works

Column	What it tells you
Control	The label of the button, field or choice, exactly as on screen. If only some roles see it, the roles are named.
What it does and when to use it	The action, and the situation it is for.
Why it exists	The rule, risk or research requirement behind it. When a button is greyed out, this is usually where the reason is.
What happens next	What you will see or what will have changed afterwards, including any confirmation and whether it is audited.

The other manuals

- **Role Guides 1 to 8** teach each role its routine, step by step. Each ends with this reference cut down to that role.
- **System Manual**: how the whole system works and how the parts fit together.
- **RA Training Manual**: learn by doing, with practice exercises.

2. Rules that apply on every screen

- **The menu shows only your screens.** The server builds it from your role. A screen that is not yours says “This screen isn't part of your role”.
- **Read-only roles see no write buttons.** Supervisors and Analysts can open their screens but every button that would change something is replaced by a note. Each Role Guide's appendix lists only what its role can see.
- **A greyed-out button is waiting for something.** Usually a required note, a required choice, or a step that must come first (for example Include is greyed out until authenticity is assessed). The “Why it exists” column says which.
- **Confirmations protect what cannot be undone.** Moving many cases, recording a withdrawal, removing a file, regenerating a draft and submitting to KoboToolbox all ask first.
- **Notes are required where a decision needs a reason.** QA decisions, closing a QA exception, activating a Reserve case and recording a withdrawal cannot be saved without one.
- **Important actions are audited.** Decisions, downloads, submissions, withdrawals, activations and status changes are recorded with who, what and when. The audit log cannot be edited.
- **Nothing personal goes into web addresses.** Links that open KoboToolbox carry only system IDs, never a name.
- **Lists share one set of controls.** Every register has a **Show** choice (10, 20, 50, 100 or 200 rows per page; your choice is remembered), page numbers, **Previous** and **Next** and first/last page arrows, and usually a **Search** box.

3. Who can open which screen

A tick means the role can open the screen. Detail screens (a case, a KII record, a document) follow their register. The columns are: PI, Field Coordinator (FC), Contact RA (CRA), QA RA (QA), KII RA (KII), Documentary RA (DOC), Analyst (AN), Supervisor (SUP). Supervisors and Analysts open screens read-only.

Screen	PI	FC	CRA	QA	KII	DOC	AN	SUP
Executive Dashboard	✓	✓					✓	✓
Sampling Dashboard	✓	✓					✓	✓
Contact Dashboard	✓	✓					✓	✓
QA Dashboard	✓	✓		✓				✓
KII / Document Dashboard	✓	✓			✓	✓	✓	✓
Reports	✓	✓					✓	✓
Main-400 Register (and Reserve)	✓	✓	✓					✓
Case page	✓	✓	✓					✓
Pre-Interview Profile (PROIT) and its review screen	✓	✓						✓
Register Organisation	✓	✓						✓
Appointment Queue	✓	✓	✓					✓
Follow-ups due	✓	✓	✓					✓
Reserve Activation	✓	✓						✓
QA Queue (with the KoboToolbox sync panel)	✓	✓		✓				✓
QA Exceptions	✓	✓		✓				✓
KII Register	✓	✓			✓			✓
New KII Record	✓	✓			✓			
KII record	✓	✓			✓			✓
Documents (the corpus)	✓	✓				✓		✓
New Documentary Evidence Record	✓	✓				✓		
Document record	✓	✓				✓		✓
Auto-fill review screen	✓	✓				✓		✓
Completed forms (Form PDFs)	✓	✓		✓	✓	✓		✓
Cost Dashboard	✓	✓					✓	✓
Audit Log	✓							
Export	✓	✓					✓	

4. Signing in and your account

4.1 Sign in

Who can open it: every role. **Where:** /admin/login

Where every staff member starts. Staff accounts are created by the PI; there is no self-registration.

Control	What it does and when to use it	Why it exists	What happens next
Username	Type the username the PI gave you.	Every action in the portal is recorded against a named person, so accounts are never shared.	Nothing yet; you also need the password.
Password	Type your password. The characters are hidden.	Passwords are never shown or emailed; the PI can reset yours but cannot read it.	Nothing yet; select Sign in.
Sign in	Checks your username and password and opens your start screen (the first screen your role uses).	Repeated wrong attempts from one network are refused for a minute, to stop password guessing.	Your start screen opens. A wrong password says so. "Too many sign-in attempts" means wait a minute.

4.2 The header and menu bar (every screen)

Who can open it: every role. **Where:** (top of every screen)

Shown at the top of every signed-in screen. The menu bar lists only the screens your role may open.

Control	What it does and when to use it	Why it exists	What happens next
Menu bar (Executive, Sampling, ... Audit)	Opens a screen. The current screen is underlined.	The list is built by the server from your role, so you never see a screen that would refuse you.	The screen opens. A screen not in your list shows "This screen isn't part of your role".
Change password	Opens the Change Password screen.	You should change the first password you were given, and any password you think someone saw.	The Change Password screen opens.
Sign out	Ends your session on this device.	Protects the data if the device is shared or lost. Always sign out on a shared device.	Your session on this device ends and you return to the Sign in screen.
← Back to ... (top left)	Returns to the parent screen (for example from a case to the register).	A consistent way back that does not lose your place in the menu.	The parent screen opens.
Go to my start screen	Appears on the "This screen isn't part of your role" page and takes you to your own start screen.	An old bookmark or shared link may point at a screen that belongs to another role; this gets you out safely.	Your start screen opens.

4.3 Change Password

Who can open it: every role. **Where:** /admin/account

Change your own password.

Control	What it does and when to use it	Why it exists	What happens next
Current password	Type the password you use now.	Proves it is really you before a change, in case a signed-in device was left open.	Nothing yet.
New password	Type the new password.	It must be long enough, not a common password, not all digits and not similar to your username or name; the screen says which rule failed.	Nothing yet.
Confirm new password	Type the new password again.	Catches a typing slip that would lock you out.	Nothing yet.
Change password	Saves the new password.	Your old password stops working straight away, and other people (including the PI) never see your new one.	A confirmation appears. Use the new password next time.

5. Dashboards and Reports (read-only)

5.1 Executive Dashboard

Who can open it: PI / System Admin, Field / Digital Coordinator, Data Analyst, Supervisor. **Where:** /admin/dashboard

The one-page picture of the study: how many cases are where in the funnel, response and quality headlines, and the weakest parts of the sample. Counts and rates only; never a name.

Control	What it does and when to use it	Why it exists	What happens next
Tiles: QUAN completed, KII completed, Documents coded, Days to data lock, Fieldwork expenditure to date	Show the headline counts against their targets, the days left to the data lock (30 November 2026) and the spend so far. Read them; there is nothing to press.	Aggregates only, so the dashboards are safe to show to people who must not see respondent identities.	Numbers update whenever the screen is opened or refreshed.
Highest-risk coverage gaps	Lists the strata (province × organisation type × size) with the lowest fill so far.	Tells the coordinator where fieldwork effort is most needed to meet the sample design.	Use it to decide where to send Contact RAs next.
Links: Sampling, Contact, QA, KII / Documents, Cost	Open the related dashboards.	Saves hunting through the menu.	The linked screen opens.

5.2 Sampling Dashboard

Who can open it: PI / System Admin, Field / Digital Coordinator, Data Analyst, Supervisor. **Where:** /admin/dashboard/sampling

How the Main-400 and Reserve-400 samples stand.

Control	What it does and when to use it	Why it exists	What happens next
Main-400 by province	Shows how many Main cases each province holds and how many are verified.	The design fixes how many organisations each province must contribute.	Read only.
Verified / total by stratum	Shows verification progress in each stratum.	A stratum that cannot be verified may need a Reserve replacement.	Read only.
Reserve activations by reason	Counts Reserve cases activated, by the authorised reason.	Reserve replacement is controlled and audited; this shows how often and why it happens.	Read only. “No reserve activations yet” until one is made.

5.3 Contact Dashboard

Who can open it: PI / System Admin, Field / Digital Coordinator, Data Analyst, Supervisor. **Where:** /admin/dashboard/contact

Contact activity: how many are invited, reminded, reached, and how appointments stand.

Control	What it does and when to use it	Why it exists	What happens next
Contact figures	Show counts of contacts, reminders and appointments by status.	Lets the coordinator see whether contact is on schedule without opening cases.	Read only.

5.4 QA Dashboard

Who can open it: PI / System Admin, Field / Digital Coordinator, QUAN/Kobo QA RA, Supervisor. **Where:** /admin/dashboard/qa

Quality checking at a glance: how many questionnaires wait for a decision and how the completed ones were done.

Control	What it does and when to use it	Why it exists	What happens next
Refresh	Re-reads the figures now.	The page does not update by itself while you watch it.	The numbers reload; the button says Refreshing... briefly.
Administration mode	Shows how many questionnaires were completed by each mode (web, telephone, WhatsApp-assisted, face to face).	Mode balance is a quality and method question for the study.	Read only.
Open QA queue	Goes to the QA Queue.	Takes you from the overview to the work.	The QA Queue opens.
Try again	Appears if the figures could not load; tries once more.	A dropped connection should not leave a blank page.	The figures load, or the message stays.

5.5 KII / Document Dashboard

Who can open it: PI / System Admin, Field / Digital Coordinator, Data Analyst, Supervisor, KII RA, Documentary RA. **Where:** /admin/dashboard/kii-documents

Progress of the two qualitative strands against their targets (about 60 KIIs, 50–75 documents).

Control	What it does and when to use it	Why it exists	What happens next
KII by status	Counts KII records at each stage (prospect, invited, scheduled, completed, declined, no-show).	Shows how far the interview target has come.	Read only.
Documents by type / by QA status	Counts documents by type (official, secondary, platform) and by decision (pending, included, excluded).	Only included documents count towards the corpus target.	Read only.

5.6 Reports

Who can open it: PI / System Admin, Field / Digital Coordinator, Data Analyst, Supervisor. **Where:** /admin/reports

Charts for supervision meetings and progress reports: funnel, submissions per day, coverage, time to complete, QA outcomes, modes and workflow. Counts and rates only.

Control	What it does and when to use it	Why it exists	What happens next
Last 7 days / Last 30 days / Last 90 days / All time	Sets the period the time-based charts cover.	Meetings usually ask “what happened this week or month”. Case progress is always cumulative.	Every time-based chart redraws for that period.
Province / Organisation type / Size	Changes what the coverage chart is broken down by.	Coverage matters along all three design dimensions.	The coverage chart redraws.
Show table / Show chart	Switches one chart between its picture and the numbers behind it.	Every chart is available as a table so numbers can be read out, copied or checked.	The chart is replaced by a table (and back).

6. The sample and contact

6.1 Main-400 Register (and Reserve)

Who can open it: PI / System Admin, Field / Digital Coordinator, Contact RA, Supervisor. **Where:** /admin/sample

The list of sample cases. A Contact RA sees only the cases assigned to them. From here you open a case, and the coordinator moves or reassigns cases in bulk.

Control	What it does and when to use it	Why it exists	What happens next
Main / Reserve (sample type)	Switches the list between the 400 Main cases and the 400 locked Reserve cases.	Reserve cases are locked replacements and are handled differently from Main cases.	The list changes and returns to page 1.
Search ID or organisation	Filters the list as you type.	Finding one case among hundreds should not need paging.	Only matching cases are listed.
Register organisation (the PI, the Field Coordinator only)	Opens Register Organisation to add an organisation that is not yet in the sample.	Late additions must get a proper Master ID and a sample case.	The Register Organisation screen opens.
View	Opens the case page for that row.	All work on a case happens on its own page.	The case page opens.
Move through verification: step, How many, Move all N (the PI, the Field Coordinator only)	Moves every Main case at one verification step (S00→S01, S01→S02, S02→S03) to the next after you confirm.	All 400 cases start at S00; verifying them one by one would take days, and a status should only advance when the checks behind it are done.	A confirmation asks first. Then “Moved N cases”, and the register updates.
Reassign cases: From, Province, How many, To, Move cases (the PI, the Field Coordinator only)	Moves a chosen number of cases (in Sample ID order) from one Contact RA, or from Unassigned, to another RA (or to nobody).	Workload has to be balanced; moving in ID order lets you split a large province between RAs in two steps.	A confirmation asks first, then the cases appear in the new RA's register.
Show / page numbers / Previous / Next	Chooses how many rows to see (10, 20, 50, 100 or 200) and moves between pages.	Different jobs need different views; your choice is remembered.	The list redraws at the chosen size.

6.2 Case page

Who can open it: PI / System Admin, Field / Digital Coordinator, Contact RA, Supervisor. **Where:** /admin/sample/{Sample ID}

Everything about one organisation's place in the sample: who to contact, the invitation, the questionnaire, the timeline and the case's status.

Control	What it does and when to use it	Why it exists	What happens next
Advance workflow status (→ S0x buttons)	Moves the case to the next valid status, for example from Eligible respondent identified to Invitation prepared.	The workflow is a fixed sequence (S00–S16): a case cannot skip steps, and each move is recorded. Only statuses that are allowed next are shown.	The status changes and the change is added to the audit log. “No further transitions” appears at a final status.
Respondents and contact details → Add a person	Records a person at the organisation: name, role, phone, WhatsApp, email, gatekeeper, and whether they are eligible.	Invitations, reminders and phone-assisted interviews all need to know who to contact and whether they are the right (senior, knowledgeable) person.	A form opens. After Save, the person is listed on the case.
Respondents panel → Edit / Save / Cancel	Corrects a person's details. Save keeps the change; Cancel discards it.	Contact details go stale, and a wrong number wastes a whole reminder sequence.	The person's details update; Cancel leaves them unchanged.
Eligibility (Not yet screened / Eligible / Not eligible)	Records the outcome of your eligibility screening of that person.	Someone not eligible must never receive the questionnaire: the system will not hand out the questionnaire link without a passed eligibility check and the person's consent.	Eligible lets the questionnaire link work once consent is given. Not eligible sends the respondent to a referral instead.
Assigned Contact RA (the PI, the Field Coordinator only)	Chooses which Contact RA works this case (or Unassigned).	A Contact RA sees only their assigned cases.	The RA's register now shows (or no longer shows) the case.
Matched Reserve case (the PI, the Field Coordinator only)	Pairs this Main case with a locked Reserve case from the same stratum.	If the Main organisation drops out, its matched Reserve is the replacement, keeping the sample balanced.	The pair is saved. Activating the Reserve later still needs an authorised reason and an evidence note.
Invitations → Issue invitation (Channel, Wave)	Creates a personal invitation link (valid 14 days) and an 8-character manual code, for the chosen channel and wave.	Respondents are invited by a private, expiring link. The link is shown once and only a scrambled form is stored, so a stolen database cannot reveal live links. A new invitation replaces the old one.	The link and code appear once, ready to send. If the case cannot be invited (for example a locked Reserve case) you are told why.
Send via WhatsApp / Send by SMS / Open in email app	Opens WhatsApp, your SMS app or your email program with the invitation message already written.	The portal does not send messages itself: you send from the study's own account so replies come to you.	Your messaging app opens with the text. Send it, then log it on the Contact timeline.
Send email (from the portal) / Copy message	Sends the invitation email from the portal (if email is set up), or copies the text so you can paste it anywhere.	Some respondents prefer email; copying is the fallback for any other channel.	“Sent to ...” or “Copied”.
Revoke	Cancels an invitation so its link stops working.	Use if it went to the wrong person or the wrong address; it is also how a wrong send is undone.	The link stops working at once and the invitation is shown as revoked.

Control	What it does and when to use it	Why it exists	What happens next
Log a contact attempt (Channel, Outcome, Notes, Log contact attempt)	Adds an entry to the Contact timeline: how you tried, what happened (Reached, No answer, Wrong number, Refused, Rescheduled, Completed) and a note.	The timeline is the study's record of effort. It shows why a case is nonresponsive and protects respondents from being contacted twice by mistake.	The entry appears at the top of the timeline with your name and the time.
Record a withdrawal (Reason, How they told us, Record withdrawal)	Records that the participant wants to withdraw. You give the reason and whether they told you by phone or in person, or in writing.	A participant's right to withdraw must take effect at once and completely: their consent is recorded as withdrawn, every open invitation is revoked, reminders stop, and their phone, WhatsApp, email and gatekeeper contact are erased.	A confirmation warns that it cannot be undone. The case moves to Refused (a case already submitted keeps its status). Any answers already submitted are kept but left out of the analysis export and flagged.
Completed questionnaire → Download PDF	Downloads the participant's completed questionnaire as a readable PDF.	A readable copy is needed for QA notes and for the participant if they ask.	A PDF downloads. The download is recorded in the audit log.
Pre-Interview Profile (PROIT) panel (the PI, the Field Coordinator, Supervisors only)	Coordinator's tool for background research on the organisation before an interview. See the PROIT screen entry.	Public facts are found before contact so the respondent is asked to confirm them, not to repeat them.	See the PROIT entry.

6.3 Pre-Interview Profile (PROIT) and its review screen

Who can open it: PI / System Admin, Field / Digital Coordinator, Supervisor. **Where:** (panel on the case page) · `/admin/proit/{id}`

Records what is publicly known about an organisation and its respondent, each fact with a source, so the interview confirms facts instead of asking for them again. Never a private or inferred fact.

Control	What it does and when to use it	Why it exists	What happens next
Start background research	Creates the pre-profile for this case.	Research is recorded only when someone deliberately starts it for a case.	The panel opens with an empty list of background fields.
Add a background field (Select a field, What was found, Add field)	Adds one fact, for example a working capital facility, from a fixed catalogue of allowed fields.	Only listed, documented kinds of fact can be recorded; health, religion, ethnicity, politics and inferred finances are never collected.	The field appears in the list, waiting for a source.
Add source	Attaches the source that shows the fact (for example a registry entry).	Every fact with a documentary value needs at least one source so it can be checked.	The source is listed under the field.
Insert suggestion	Inserts a suggested probe question for the chosen role, using your evidence.	Saves writing role-specific questions from scratch and keeps interviews consistent.	The suggestion is added above for you to keep, edit or delete.

Control	What it does and when to use it	Why it exists	What happens next
Gap-engine notes: Known, Unknown, Contradictions, Priority probe questions, Role-specific module, short form → Save gap-engine notes	Records what is already established, what is missing, where sources disagree, and what to ask first.	Focuses the interview on real gaps and reduces the burden on the respondent.	The notes are saved; the panel shows how many background questions became verifications.
Lock pre-profile	Finalises the profile.	A locked profile is the version the interview is planned from; it cannot be quietly changed afterwards. It cannot be locked while a fact still has no source.	The profile becomes read-only.
Researcher review screen (link)	Opens a one-page summary: case, organisation, evidence, bankability context, gap summary and interview plan.	One readable page for the researcher to read before the interview.	Read only; sensitive items to avoid are listed at the bottom.

6.4 Register Organisation

Who can open it: PI / System Admin, Field / Digital Coordinator, Supervisor. **Where:** /admin/organisations

Adds an organisation that is not already in the sample and gives it a Master ID and, if wanted, a sample case.

Control	What it does and when to use it	Why it exists	What happens next
Name, District, Province, Entity type, Actor family, Value chain, Size class	Describe the organisation. Name is required.	These are the sample's design dimensions (province × organisation type × size) so the new organisation lands in the right stratum.	Nothing is saved until you select Register organisation.
Register organisation	Saves the organisation.	The Master ID is generated automatically from the province, so IDs are never typed or reused.	"{name} registered — {Master ID}" appears with the option to create its case.
Sample type (Main / Reserve) and Create sample case	Creates the organisation's case as a Main or a Reserve case.	Only an organisation with a case can be worked; Reserve cases start locked.	The case is created with a Sample ID; a link to the Main-400 Register appears.
Search name, Master ID or district	Filters the list of registered organisations.	Avoids registering the same organisation twice.	Only matching organisations are listed.
Create sample case (per row)	Creates a case later for an organisation registered without one.	Registering and creating the case are separate steps so neither is forced.	The case is created.

6.5 Appointment Queue

Who can open it: PI / System Admin, Field / Digital Coordinator, Contact RA, Supervisor. **Where:** /admin/appointments

Calls that respondents have asked for, and their progress.

Control	What it does and when to use it	Why it exists	What happens next
Filter by status	Shows all appointments, or only Requested, Confirmed, Completed, Missed or Cancelled.	Coordinators mostly need the ones still to be acted on.	The list changes and returns to page 1.
CONFIRMED / CANCELLED (on a Requested appointment)	Confirm the time with the respondent and select CONFIRMED, or CANCELLED if it will not happen.	A respondent's request is only a request until a person confirms it.	The appointment's status changes.
COMPLETED / MISSED / CANCELLED (on a Confirmed appointment)	Record what happened at the appointment time.	Missed calls need to be rescheduled and counted; completed ones move the case forward.	The status changes; finished appointments show no more buttons.
Show / page numbers	Choose rows per page and move between pages.	As on every register.	The list redraws.

6.6 Follow-ups due

Who can open it: PI / System Admin, Field / Digital Coordinator, Contact RA, Supervisor. **Where:** /admin/follow-ups

Approved reminders (on days 0, 2, 4–5 and 7 after an invitation) for invited cases that have not responded.

Control	What it does and when to use it	Why it exists	What happens next
Case link (Sample ID)	Opens the case the reminder is for.	Lets you check the case before you send.	The case page opens.
Open in WhatsApp	Opens WhatsApp with the reminder text already written for that respondent.	Reminders are sent by a person from the study's WhatsApp account: nothing is sent automatically, so a person always decides.	WhatsApp opens with the message. If the button says "Open WhatsApp (choose contact)", there is no number on file: pick the contact in WhatsApp, and add the number on the case afterwards.
Mark as sent	Tells the portal you sent the reminder.	Otherwise the same reminder stays due and could be sent twice.	It is recorded as sent by you and leaves the list.

6.7 Reserve Activation

Who can open it: PI / System Admin, Field / Digital Coordinator, Supervisor. **Where:** /admin/reserve

Where a locked Reserve case is activated to replace a Main case that has dropped out.

Control	What it does and when to use it	Why it exists	What happens next
Search ID or organisation	Finds a locked Reserve case.	There are 400 locked cases.	Only matching cases are listed.

Control	What it does and when to use it	Why it exists	What happens next
Select authorised reason	Chooses why: Ineligible, Inactive, Duplicate, Refusal or Nonresponse exhausted.	A Reserve case is a scarce, matched replacement. Only these reasons are allowed so replacement cannot be used to swap in a friendlier organisation.	Nothing yet; you also need an evidence note.
Evidence note (required)	Write what shows the reason is true.	Every activation must be defensible later, in the dissertation or an audit.	Nothing yet; select Activate.
Activate	Unlocks the Reserve case so it can be invited.	The one controlled way a Reserve case becomes usable. The reason, note and your name are kept.	The case leaves the locked list and can be invited; the activation is audited.

7. Quality checking

7.1 QA Queue (with the KoboToolbox sync panel)

Who can open it: PI / System Admin, Field / Digital Coordinator, QUAN/Kobo QA RA, Supervisor. **Where:** /admin/qa

Every completed questionnaire waits here for a human quality decision. Nothing is ever passed automatically.

Control	What it does and when to use it	Why it exists	What happens next
KoboToolbox sync → Sync now	Pulls completed questionnaires from KoboToolbox right now, instead of waiting for the automatic check (every 15 minutes).	KoboToolbox is where the questionnaire is answered; the portal has to fetch what was submitted. A new or edited submission enters the queue when it is fetched.	A summary shows how many were new or changed. “Not connected” or “Last sync failed” explains a problem; the automatic check keeps trying.
Note (required)	Write what you checked and found (for example “duration 28 min plausible, no duplicate”).	A decision nobody explained looks the same as one nobody made; the note is what a later reviewer relies on.	The decision buttons stay off until there is a note.
Accept	Records that the submission passed quality checking.	Only a person can pass a questionnaire; even one that triggered no rule is not passed until someone accepts it.	The submission is marked QA passed, the case moves on, and the decision is audited.
Re-query	Sends the submission back with a question about what needs confirming or fixing.	Some problems (an odd answer, a very short time) need the respondent or interviewer to clarify before a decision.	The submission is marked as queried and the case moves to “QA query”. If the answers are edited in KoboToolbox, the next sync puts it back in the queue.
Reject	Records that the submission fails and will not be used.	Fabricated, duplicate or unusable data must be kept out of the analysis, but never silently deleted.	The submission is marked rejected. It is kept and the decision and your note are audited.

7.2 QA Exceptions

Who can open it: PI / System Admin, Field / Digital Coordinator, QUAN/Kobo QA RA, Supervisor. **Where:** /admin/qa/exceptions

Flags the automatic quality rules raised (for example a very short completion time). Each waits for someone to deal with it and explain what was done.

Control	What it does and when to use it	Why it exists	What happens next
Only mine	Shows just the exceptions assigned to you.	Lets each QA person work their own list.	The list narrows and returns to page 1.

Control	What it does and when to use it	Why it exists	What happens next
Include resolved	Also shows exceptions that were already closed.	Useful for checking what was done before, or how similar flags were handled.	Closed exceptions appear with who closed them, when and why.
Assign to	Chooses who deals with the exception, or Unassigned.	So each flag has an owner and none is left for "someone".	The exception appears in that person's "Only mine" list.
What was done about it? (required to close)	Write what you did (what you checked, who you contacted).	A closure nobody explained looks the same as one nobody looked at.	The two closing buttons stay off until there is a note.
Resolved	Closes the exception because you dealt with a real problem.	Distinguishes "there was a problem and it was fixed" from a false alarm, so rules can be tuned.	The exception is closed with your name, the time and your note.
Not a real problem	Closes the exception because the flag was a false alarm.	False alarms are information too: many of them means a rule threshold may be wrong.	The exception is closed as dismissed, with your note.

8. Key Informant Interviews

8.1 KII Register

Who can open it: PI / System Admin, Field / Digital Coordinator, KII RA, Supervisor. **Where:** /admin/kii

All Key Informant Interview records. Each record identifies a real person, so nothing here leaves the study team.

Control	What it does and when to use it	Why it exists	What happens next
New KII record (the PI, the Field Coordinator, KII RAs only)	Opens the form to create a KII record.	Each interview gets its own record and KII ID from the start of contact.	The New KII Record screen opens.
Search KII ID, name or role	Filters the list as you type.	Finding one participant among dozens.	Only matching records are listed.
Manage	Opens the KII record.	All work on an interview happens on its own record.	The KII record opens.
Show / page numbers	Choose rows per page and move between pages.	As on every register.	The list redraws.

8.2 New KII Record

Who can open it: PI / System Admin, Field / Digital Coordinator, KII RA. **Where:** /admin/kii/new

Starts the record for one interview.

Control	What it does and when to use it	Why it exists	What happens next
Stakeholder category, Participant name, Participant role, Preferred mode	Say who the participant is and how they prefer to be interviewed.	The category places the interview in the KII design; the name and role are needed to arrange it. They stay in the portal and are never put into web addresses.	Nothing is saved until you select Create KII record.
Create KII record	Saves the record.	The KII ID (for example KII-0026) is generated by the system so it is never typed or reused.	The record opens at its starting status, with no consent recorded yet.

8.3 KII record

Who can open it: PI / System Admin, Field / Digital Coordinator, KII RA, Supervisor. **Where:** /admin/kii/{id}

The whole life of one interview: status, consent, the interview itself, transcript and coding.

Control	What it does and when to use it	Why it exists	What happens next
Status buttons (INVITED, SCHEDULED, COMPLETED, DECLINED, NO_SHOW)	Move the interview to the next status as things happen. Only valid next statuses are shown: a prospect can be invited or decline; an invited person scheduled or decline; a scheduled interview completed, no-show or decline; a no-show can be rescheduled.	A status should only follow what really happened, and COMPLETED, DECLINED are final.	The status changes and is audited. A final status shows no more buttons.
Recording made (tick box, when marking COMPLETED)	Tick it only if the interview was audio-recorded.	A recorded interview needs the participant's separate recording consent; the portal refuses to complete it as recorded without that.	If recording consent is missing you are told, and the status does not change.
Record participation consent	Records that the participant agreed to take part, after you read or summarised the information sheet.	Nobody is interviewed without consent. The interview link stays hidden until this is recorded.	The consent is recorded (with the information sheet version). Continue this interview appears.
Record recording consent	Records that the participant agreed to be audio-recorded.	Recording consent is always a separate decision; it is never assumed from taking part.	Recording consent is recorded and a recorded interview can be completed.
Continue this interview (the PI, the Field Coordinator, KII RAs only)	Opens the KoboToolbox KII Guide in a new tab with this record's KII ID already filled in.	So the completed form always matches this record and the ID can never be mistyped. Only the ID and your username are sent, never the participant's name.	The KoboToolbox form opens. When submitted, the completed form appears under Completed KII form.
Transcript status (NOT_STARTED, IN_PROGRESS, VERIFIED, ANONYMISED)	Record how far the transcript has got.	A transcript must be verified and anonymised before it can be analysed or quoted.	The status changes and cannot go backwards.
Coding status (NOT_STARTED, IN_PROGRESS, COMPLETE)	Record how far the coding has got. It moves to COMPLETE by itself when the completed KII Guide is synced for this KII ID.	Shows what has and has not been analysed.	The status changes and cannot go backwards.
Completed KII form → Download PDF	Downloads the completed KII Guide for this record as a readable PDF.	A readable copy without opening KoboToolbox.	A PDF downloads; the download is audited.

9. Documentary evidence

9.1 Documents (the corpus)

Who can open it: PI / System Admin, Field / Digital Coordinator, Documentary RA, Supervisor. **Where:** /admin/documents

The register of documentary evidence (target 50–75 coded, included documents).

Control	What it does and when to use it	Why it exists	What happens next
New document (the PI, the Field Coordinator, Documentary RAs only)	Opens the New Documentary Evidence Record screen.	Every source needs a record with a document ID before it can be coded.	The New document screen opens.
Search title, ID or author	Filters the list as you type.	Finding one document in 100 or more.	Only matching documents are listed.
Manage	Opens the document record.	All work on a document happens on its own record.	The document record opens.
Show / page numbers	Choose rows per page and move between pages.	As on every register.	The list redraws.

9.2 New Documentary Evidence Record

Who can open it: PI / System Admin, Field / Digital Coordinator, Documentary RA. **Where:** /admin/documents/new

Creates a document record. The fastest way is to upload the file and let the AI fill in the record and draft the coding form.

Control	What it does and when to use it	Why it exists	What happens next
Choose file (Fastest: upload the document)	Choose the document: PDF, Word, Excel, text or CSV, or a JPG/PNG scan or photo (up to 20 MB).	The AI can read all of these, so you do not retype details that are already on the first page.	Nothing is sent until you select Upload and auto-fill.
Optional: Title	Type a title of your own.	You may want a specific name, for example for one chapter of a report.	A typed title is kept; the AI does not replace it.
Optional: Pages to read	Enter the pages of a long PDF that make up this evidence unit, for example 290-340.	The AI reads at most 100 pages at a time, and a long report holds several evidence units.	Only those pages are read. With no title, the AI names the part.
Optional: Read the whole document in parts	Ticks the option to read a PDF longer than 100 pages in parts of about 80 pages, then combine them.	For a document you want coded as one unit; slower and dearer, and the ratings need extra checking.	The screen shows how many parts and asks you to confirm before it starts.

Control	What it does and when to use it	Why it exists	What happens next
Upload and auto-fill	Creates the record, uploads the file, and starts the AI: first it fills in the record's details, then it drafts the whole coding form.	Saves typing every detail and every answer; a person still reviews and submits.	The review screen opens and shows "Step 1 of 2... Step 2 of 2". If the file cannot be used, nothing is created.
Title, Author / speaker, Source URL / reference, Document type, Geographic scope, Evidence extract → Create document record	The manual way: type the details yourself and save.	For a source with no file yet, or when AI drafting is switched off.	The record is created with a document ID (for example DOC-0025) and opens.

9.3 Document record

Who can open it: PI / System Admin, Field / Digital Coordinator, Documentary RA, Supervisor. **Where:** /admin/documents/{id}

Everything about one document: authenticity, the decision to include it, its file, its details, its coding and its memo.

Control	What it does and when to use it	Why it exists	What happens next
Mark verified / Mark disputed	Records your judgement of whether the document is what it claims to be: the right author, date and content.	Documents are evidence; a forged or doubtful one must not enter the corpus unnoticed. Disputed documents are kept and explained, not deleted.	The authenticity changes and is audited. Include becomes available once assessed.
Include / Exclude	Decides whether the document counts in the corpus.	A document cannot be Included until authenticity has been assessed, so unassessed evidence never counts.	The QA status changes; Include stays greyed out while authenticity is Unverified.
Source file → Choose File	Uploads or replaces the source (up to 20 MB). Replacing removes the old file and any unsubmitted draft made from it.	The record keeps one current source. A draft of the wrong document must never be submitted for the right one.	A bar shows progress, then the file name appears. With Start Auto-fill ticked, the review screen opens.
Start Auto-fill as soon as the file is uploaded (tick box)	When ticked, uploading immediately starts the AI draft.	Saves a step for the common case.	After the upload, the review screen opens and the AI starts reading.
Remove file	Deletes the source file from the server.	For a wrong upload. It also discards the unsubmitted AI draft made from it; a draft already submitted is kept as the record of what was filed.	A confirmation names what goes. The record says "No file uploaded yet".

Control	What it does and when to use it	Why it exists	What happens next
Copy for another chapter (Chapter title, Pages to read, Copy and auto-fill)	Makes another record for a different part of the same source: same author, date, source and type, and its own copy of the file.	A long report holds several evidence units, each of which should be coded, judged and exported on its own.	A new record is created (and, with AI on, drafted) and opens. Authenticity and inclusion are not copied.
Record details → Save details	Edits the title, author, date, source, scope, value chain and type.	These feed Section A of the coding form; if the AI filled them in from the document, this is where you check and correct them.	“Details saved.” The draft and the submission use the corrected values.
Code this document	Opens the KoboToolbox Document Analysis Tool with the document ID and details filled in.	For coding by hand, or when the AI cannot read the source.	The KoboToolbox form opens in a new tab.
Auto-fill	Opens the review screen for the AI draft of the whole coding form.	A fast first draft that a person then checks.	The Auto-fill review screen opens.
Interpretive memo → Save memo	Writes down your reasoning: why authenticity was disputed, how you read the document.	The memo is the audit trail of your judgement, needed for the dissertation.	A “saved” message; the memo stays on the record.
Completed coding form → Download PDF	Downloads the completed coding form for this document.	A readable copy of what was submitted.	A PDF downloads (only if a form was submitted with this document ID).

9.4 Auto-fill review screen

Who can open it: PI / System Admin, Field / Digital Coordinator, Documentary RA, Supervisor. **Where:** /admin/documents/{id}/ai-draft

Where you review the AI's draft of the KoboToolbox coding form, edit it and submit it. Nothing reaches KoboToolbox until you select Submit.

Control	What it does and when to use it	Why it exists	What happens next
Pages to read	For a PDF over 100 pages, enter the pages that make up this evidence unit.	The AI reads at most 100 pages at a time.	Only those pages are drafted; locators keep the original page numbers.
Read the whole document in parts	Reads the whole PDF (or a long range) in parts of about 80 pages and combines them.	For one coding of a long document; costs about the number of parts plus one times an ordinary draft.	You are asked to confirm. Progress shows “Read part 3 of 8”, then “Combining the parts”.
Generate AI draft / Regenerate draft	Starts the AI reading the source. Regenerate replaces the current draft and any unsaved edits.	Each draft is a paid request, so it starts only when you ask; regenerating asks first because it discards your edits.	The AI works in the background (usually one to five minutes) and you can leave the page. The draft appears here when ready.

Control	What it does and when to use it	Why it exists	What happens next
The draft fields (sections A to L)	Every question of the form, with the AI's answer. Edit any grey-free field: text, choices, tick boxes, dates.	The AI drafts; you are responsible for the judgements (strength ratings, hypothesis codes) that are the study's documentary analysis.	Edits are kept in the browser until you select Save changes.
Section A grey fields (DOC ID, author, title, date, source)	Come from the record and cannot be edited here; use "edit the record details".	The draft must agree with the record it is attached to.	Corrections on the record show here at once and are the values submitted.
Add metric / Remove this metric (Section J)	Adds or deletes a row of the quantitative metrics table.	Numbers in the source (percentages, amounts, targets) are recorded one per row with a locator.	The row is added or removed in the draft.
Save changes	Saves your edits to the draft on the server.	Lets you stop and finish later without submitting.	"Changes saved." The button is unavailable after submission.
Submit to KoboToolbox	Sends the reviewed draft to KoboToolbox as a completed record, after you confirm. It saves your edits first.	The one place the portal writes to KoboToolbox, and only on this deliberate click: a person, not the AI, submits the study's documentary analysis. Once only, so no duplicate.	"Submitted to KoboToolbox, and a copy is now held in the portal." The answers lock and the screen says "Already submitted". A second click is refused.

10. Completed forms and exports

10.1 Completed forms (Form PDFs)

Who can open it: PI / System Admin, Field / Digital Coordinator, QUAN/Kobo QA RA, KII RA, Documentary RA, Supervisor. **Where:** /admin/submissions

The completed KoboToolbox forms for your role (the questionnaire, the KII Guide or the Document Analysis Tool; the PI, coordinator and supervisor can switch between all three).

Control	What it does and when to use it	Why it exists	What happens next
Form (drop-down) (the PI, the Field Coordinator, Supervisors only)	Chooses which form to list. Shown only to roles that may see more than one.	Each role sees only its own form, because raw answers can identify organisations and people.	The list and the sync panel change to that form.
Sync panel: "In sync with KoboToolbox"	Shows how many submissions KoboToolbox holds and how many the portal holds, and when they were last matched.	The portal keeps its own copy of the completed forms. If the two numbers differ, the portal is behind.	Read only. "Not in sync" means press Sync now.
Sync now	Pulls that form from KoboToolbox now and updates the portal's copy.	The automatic sync runs every 15 minutes; this brings it up to date immediately. It also notices edits and deletions made in KoboToolbox.	The counts refresh. A KII record's coding can move to COMPLETE; a document whose submission was deleted in KoboToolbox unlocks.
✓ saved in portal (on each row)	Says the portal holds an identical copy of that submission.	Proof, row by row, that nothing was lost or changed between KoboToolbox and the portal.	Read only. It is missing until the next sync for a new or edited row.
Download PDF	Downloads that completed form as a readable PDF (sections, questions, answers as words).	A readable copy for records, meetings and checking.	A PDF downloads; the download is audited.
Email to me	Emails that PDF to the address on your own account.	A PDF is a full research record, so it goes only to you, never to a typed-in address.	"Sent to ..." (address masked). Recorded in the audit log.
Email to respondent (questionnaire only) (the PI, the Field Coordinator, QA RAs only)	Emails the respondent a copy of their own answers, at the address on their case, after you confirm.	Respondents may ask for their answers; the copy goes only to the address on file and only while their consent stands.	A confirmation first; then "Sent to ...". Refused if consent was withdrawn or no email is on file.
Excel workbook (the PI only)	Downloads every submission of the form as an analysis-ready workbook: answers as codes and as labels, a question dictionary, choice lists, a sheet for each repeating group.	Analysis in SPSS, Stata or R needs the answers, not just the portal's case data.	An .xlsx file downloads; the download is audited.
All as PDFs (ZIP) (the PI only)	Downloads every completed form as a PDF in one ZIP with a manifest.	An archive of the completed forms for the data lock.	The download starts at once and grows as each form is added.

Control	What it does and when to use it	Why it exists	What happens next
Show / page numbers	Choose rows per page and move between pages.	As on every register.	The list redraws.

11. Study administration

11.1 Cost Dashboard

Who can open it: PI / System Admin, Field / Digital Coordinator, Data Analyst, Supervisor. **Where:** /admin/cost

What the fieldwork has cost, by category, so cost per completed case can be reported.

Control	What it does and when to use it	Why it exists	What happens next
Spend by category	Shows spend for RA allowance, airtime/data, transport, accommodation, hosting, messaging and other.	Funders and the dissertation need the real cost of each completed case.	Read only.
Log a cost event: Date, Category, Amount → Log cost (the PI, the Field Coordinator only)	Records one expense.	Costs are logged as they happen so the total stays true, and each event records who approved it.	The event is added and the total increases by that amount.

11.2 Audit Log

Who can open it: PI / System Admin. **Where:** /admin/audit

The permanent record of who did what and when: QA decisions, downloads, emails of copies, submissions to KoboToolbox, withdrawals, reserve activations, status changes and other changes to records.

Control	What it does and when to use it	Why it exists	What happens next
The list of events	Shows each action with who did it, what it was done to and when, newest first.	Research governance needs to be able to show who handled sensitive data and made key decisions. Entries are added by the system and cannot be edited or deleted.	Read only.
Show / page numbers	Choose rows per page and move between pages.	The log grows quickly; a larger page helps when searching for one event.	The list redraws.

11.3 Export

Who can open it: PI / System Admin, Field / Digital Coordinator, Data Analyst. **Where:** /admin/export

Downloads of data for analysis and for the data lock. Every download is audited, and the disclaimer at the foot applies to everything exported.

Control	What it does and when to use it	Why it exists	What happens next
Download analysis export (CSV)	Downloads case-level data with no contact-identifying fields (no names, phone numbers or emails). Withdrawn participants' answers are left out.	The version that is safe for analysis and for sharing with the wider research team.	A CSV downloads.
Download operational export (CSV) (the PI only)	Downloads the full operational data including contact details. PI only.	Needed for fieldwork administration; never to be passed outside the study.	A CSV downloads; the download is audited.
KoboToolbox data → Excel workbook / All completed forms (PDF ZIP), for each form (the PI only)	Downloads the full answers of the Questionnaire, the KII Guide or the Document Analysis Tool, as a workbook or as PDFs. PI only.	Raw answers can identify organisations and, in the KII Guide, people, so only the PI may take them out.	The file downloads; the download is audited.